

EDUCATION

- **Seoul National University** Seoul, Korea
B.S. in Mechanical Engineering *March 2010 - Feb 2014*
- **Seoul National University** Seoul, Korea
M.S. in Mechanical Engineering - Advisor: Dongjun Lee *March 2018 - Feb 2020*
Thesis: Multi-Contact Simulator and Reinforcement Learning for Screw Tightening Tasks
- **Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)** Seoul, Korea
Ph.D. Student - AI Graduate School - HuGe Lab - Advisor: Beomjoon Kim *Sep 2022 - Present*

SKILLS SUMMARY

- **Languages:** Python, C++, MATLAB
- **Frameworks:** TensorFlow, Keras, JAX, ROS, OpenGL, PyBullet, Open3D, OMPL, FCL
- **Tools:** SolidWorks, EasyEDA

EXPERIENCE

- **Allen Institute for AI (Ai2)** Seattle, WA
Research Intern, Robotics Group *Oct 2025 - June 2026*
 - **Advisor/Mentor:** Dieter Fox
 - **Torque Adaptation:** Worked on a torque adaptation module to reduce the sim-to-real gap.
- **Samsung/Hanwha Techwin** Changwon, Korea
QA Engineer - Gas Turbine Engine Division *May 2014 - Sep 2017*
- **Samsung Research** Seoul, Korea
AI Researcher - AI Methods Team *Feb 2020 - June 2022*
 - **Data-driven Grasping:** Developed algorithms for grasping in heavily cluttered environments.
 - **Sim-to-real Transfer:** Reduced the sim-to-real gap through robot control and domain randomization.
 - **Planning:** Applied AlphaGo Zero-style search to object arrangement tasks.
 - **Data-efficient Reinforcement Learning:** Developed data-efficient reinforcement learning algorithms for vision-based object manipulation.

ENGINEERING PROJECTS

- **Manipulator Identification:** Identified physics parameters for Franka Emika Panda.
- **Manipulator Controller Design:** Implemented impedance, admittance, and compliance controllers.
- **Motor Driver Design and FOC Control:** Built PCB and MCU control stack with anticogging and FOC control.

PUBLICATIONS

- **NeuralSVCD for Efficient Swept Volume Collision Detection:** [Dongwon Son](#), Hojin Jung, and Beomjoon Kim. CoRL. 2025. [site](#)
- **DEF-oriCORN: efficient 3D scene understanding for robust language-directed pick-and-place:** [Dongwon Son](#), Sanghyeon Son, Jaehyung Kim, Hojin Jung, and Beomjoon Kim. under review. 2025. [site](#)
- **An Intuitive Multi-Frequency Feature Representation for SO(3)-Equivariant Networks:** [Dongwon Son](#), Jaehyung Kim, Sanghyeon Son, and Beomjoon Kim. ICLR. 2024. [paper](#) [site](#)
- **Preference learning for guiding the tree search in continuous POMDPs:** Jiyong Ahn, Sanghyeon Son, Dongryung Lee, Jisu Han, [Dongwon Son](#), and Beomjoon Kim. CoRL. 2023. [video](#) [paper](#) [site](#)
- **Local Object Crop Collision Network for Efficient Simulation of Non-Convex Objects in GPU-based Simulators:** [Dongwon Son](#), and Beomjoon Kim. R:SS. 2023. [video](#) [paper](#) [site](#)
- **Grasping as Inference: Reactive Grasping in Heavily Cluttered Environment:** [Dongwon Son](#). RA-L. 2022. [video](#) [paper](#)
- **Reinforcement Learning for Vision-based Object Manipulation with Non-parametric Policy and Action Primitives:** [Dongwon Son](#), Myungsin Kim, Jaechol Sim, and Wonsik Shin. IROS. 2021. [video](#) [paper](#)
- **Sim-to-Real Transfer of Bolting Tasks with Tight Tolerance:** [Dongwon Son](#), Hyunsoo Yang, and Dongjun Lee. IROS. 2020. [video](#) [paper](#)
- **Learnable Environment Model with Data Efficiency for MPC of Assembly Tasks:** [Dongwon Son](#), Hyunsoo Yang, and Dongjun Lee. IROS Workshop LRPC. 2019. [video](#) [paper](#)
- **Data-driven Contact Clustering for Robot Simulation:** Myungsin Kim, Jaemin Yoon, [Dongwon Son](#), and Dongjun Lee. ICRA. 2019. [paper](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Robot manipulation, including object manipulation, grasping, vision-based assembly, and long-horizon manipulation
- Computationally efficient simulation, including physics engines, collision detection, and rendering
- Sim-to-real transfer
- Structured network design and shape representation for manipulation and planning
- Open-source, cost-efficient manipulator design